Zihao Zhang

Contact Information

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Education

Emory University Aug 2024 - Present
- Ph.D. Student, Computer Science. Advisor: Dr. Li Xiong, Dr. Fei Liu

The University of Massachusetts Amherst Sep 2021 - Dec 2023
- M.S., Computer Science. Advisor: Dr. Hong Yu

The Pennsylvania State University Aug 2017 - May 2021
- B.S., Computer Science (Honor Program). Minor in Mathematics, Statistic, CyberSecurity

Honors and Rewards

ACL Student Area Chair Highlights Award, 2025. *PlanGenLLMs: A Modern Survey of LLM Planning Capabilities.*

Industry Experience

GenAI Research Intern May 2026 - Aug 2026
Zoom Communications, Inc. *Bellevue, WA*
- Owned the design, implementation of Zoom's next-generation agentic personalized meeting summarization end-to-end; deploying it to production to serve global users.
- Ablated harness components on SWE-bench and Terminal-Bench, diagnosing agent failures and behavior via trajectory- and command-level error analyses.

Software Engineer Intern, Full Stack Engineer May 2022 - Aug 2022
Toyz Electronics, LLC *Pittsburgh, PA*
- Deployed a Magento E-commerce store using solutions based on AWS CloudFormation.
- Configured AWS Load Balancer and S3 for faster response time and efficient data storage.

Software Engineer Intern, IT Consulting Gourp May 2020 - Aug 2020
Ernst & Young China Co., Ltd *Beijing, China*
- Developed Captial asset pricing model of a car insurance company.
- Wrote and modified the demand investigation and questionary survey.

Publications

1. Run-ze Fan*, Zihao Zhang*, Simin Ma, Yebowen Hu, Shouju Wang, Kaiqiang Song, Fei Liu, Hamed Zamani, Xiaoyang Wang(2026). **An Empirical Study of Harness Design for Coding Agents**
2. Pengshan Cai*, Zihao Zhang*, Ting Jin, Chenyang Zhu, Kushal Chawla, Sangwoo Cho, Scott Novotney, Yebowen Hu, Fei Liu, Shi-Xiong Zhang, Sambit Sahu (2026). **AREAs-Lab: An Interactive Environment for AI-driven Requirement Elicitation for AI Systems**
3. Zihao Zhang, Hui Wei, Kenan Jiang, Shijia Pan, Kai Shu, Fei Liu (2025). **Cost-Awareness in Tree-Search LLM Planning: A Systematic Study**
4. Hui Wei, Zihao Zhang, Shenghua He, Tian Xia, Shijia Pan, Fei Liu (2025). **PlangenLLMs: A Modern Survey of LLM Planning Capabilities.** *ACL 2025* (Oral presentation; trophy SAC Highlights Award (top 1%) from 8,000+ submissions;
5. Zonghai Yao, Zihao Zhang, Chaolong Tang, Xingyu Bian, Youxia Zhao, Zhichao Yang, Junda Wang, Huixue Zhou, Won Seok Jang, Feiyun Ouyang, Hong Yu (2024). **MedQA-CS: Benchmarking Large Language Models' Clinical Skills Using an AI-SCE Framework.**
6. Vijeta Deshpande, Minhwa Lee, Zonghai Yao, Zihao Zhang, Jason Brian Gibbons, Hong Yu (2024). **LocalTweets to LocalHealth: A Mental Health Surveillance Framework Based on Twitter Data.** *LREC-Coling 2024.*
7. Zihao Zhang, Zonghai Yao, Huixue Zhou, Hong Yu (2023). **EhrTutor: Enhancing Patient Understanding of Discharge Instructions.** *NeurIPS'23 Workshop on Generative AI for Education (GAIED).*

Professional Services

AREA Chair: EMNLP, ACL **Reviewer:** ICLR

Technical Skills

Programming: Python, C++, Java, LaTeX, MATLAB
Frameworks: PyTorch, Verl, LLaMA Factory, HuggingFace, LangChain, Unsloth, Pandas